



REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA

MINISTRY OF TOURISM



STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURES FOR DEVOLVED CULTURAL FUNCTIONS FOR LOCAL AUTHORITIES



JULY 2024

FOREWORD



As you are aware, Government is implementing the National Decentralisation policy in line with the provisions of the constitution. The policy provides among others, for the devolution of Cultural functions from the National Government to the Local authorities as provided under Article 147 of the Constitution of Zambia.

Government recognises the important role of the cultural sector in preserving our cultural heritage and tourism development and also its significant potential in creating employment and wealth through creative cultural industries. Consequently, the responsibility for Cultural functions will transition from the Ministry of Tourism to Local Authorities. The transfer of these functions is aimed at improving service delivery at community level and to foster greater citizen participation and decision making in local governance and development issues. It is against this background that the Government recognised the need to put in place a comprehensive document highlighting the Standard Operating Procedures for all the functions that will be devolved to the Local Authorities to guide the country and all relevant stakeholders involved in the delivery of services of the cultural sector.

I wish to urge all stakeholders to actively engage in the execution of these functions to ensure that there is marked improvement in citizen participation in the decision-making processes in the Cultural sector grass root level.

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Evans Muhanga'.

Evans Muhanga
Permanent Secretary – Ministry of Tourism

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Cultural Infrastructure	The spaces and structures that bring people together and strengthen the social and cultural fabric of our communities.
Cultural Heritage	Intangible and tangible material of outstanding value
Creative Industries	Industry that combines the creation, production and commercialisation of creative contents that are intangible and of a cultural nature.
Cultural Needs	Things that are necessary or helpful for an individual to thrive due to their cultural background.
Cultural Spaces	All publicly accessible spaces that supply the means of creative production.
Cultural Goods	Tangible items that can be produced, bought, and sold.
Cultural Services	Intangible activities or tasks performed by one party for the benefit of another.
Cultural Tourism	Tourism in which the visitor's essential motivation is to learn, discover, experience and consume the cultural attractions and products offered by a tourist destination.
Cultural Artifacts	Items that contain vital information about the people and the culture they relate to or for which they were used.
Cultural Agencies	An agency engaged in selling and arranging transportation, accommodations, tours, and trips for travelers.
Cultural Artisan	Skilled craft worker who makes or creates material objects partly or entirely by hand.
Cultural Institutions	Institutions with an acknowledged mission to engage in the conservation, interpretation and dissemination of cultural practices.

Introduction

This document outlines the Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for local authorities (LAs) to effectively manage the devolved cultural matters function. They cover a range of cultural functions including cultural infrastructure and facilities, promotion of cultural goods and services, registration of cultural entities, inventory of cultural heritage, and mobilisation of community participation in cultural and traditional affairs within their districts.

By following these guidelines, local authorities can significantly enhance their capacity and authority in managing cultural resources. They provide a structured framework for effective governance, enabling local leaders to make informed decisions and allocate resources efficiently. Moreover, the SOPs encourage the development of a vibrant cultural scene, fostering creativity, innovation, and community engagement. This can lead to a more dynamic and attractive district, attracting tourists, businesses, and talent.

The SOPs also prioritise the preservation of tangible and intangible cultural heritage. By safeguarding these valuable assets, local authorities can ensure that their district's unique identity and history are passed on to future generations. Furthermore, the SOPs support the development of cultural industries, which can create jobs, generate revenue, and attract tourists. By promoting cultural tourism, local authorities can contribute to the economic growth of their districts and improve the livelihoods of their residents.

Ultimately, the SOPs encourage community participation in cultural activities. By involving residents in the planning, implementation, and enjoyment of cultural events, local authorities can foster a sense of ownership and belonging. This can strengthen social cohesion, promote civic engagement, and create a more vibrant and inclusive community.

Overall, these SOPs are essential tools for LAs to effectively carry out their cultural responsibilities and contribute to the sustainable development of their districts.

1.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Development and Rehabilitation of Cultural Infrastructure and Facilities in Districts by Local Authorities

1.1 Introduction

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) outlines the procedures for local authorities to effectively manage the development and rehabilitation of cultural infrastructure and facilities within their district following the devolution of cultural functions. This SOP aims to assist local authorities in efficiently allocating resources and ensuring high-quality cultural facilities and spaces for the community.

1.2 Scope

- i. Establish a systematic approach for developing and rehabilitating cultural infrastructure and facilities within the district.
- ii. Ensure cultural infrastructure meets the needs of the community and supports diverse cultural activities.
- iii. Manage resource allocation efficiently for cultural projects.
- iv. Promote the preservation, protection and enhancement of the district's cultural heritage through well-maintained facilities.
- v. Facilitate documentation on the state of culture infrastructure and facilities in the district.

1.3 Purpose

This SOP applies to the development and rehabilitation of all cultural infrastructure and facilities under the control of local authorities, including:

- i. Cultural centers
- ii. Traditional museums and cultural archives
- iii. Performance venues (theaters)
- iv. Libraries with a focus on cultural heritage materials

1.4. Roles and Responsibilities

1.4.1 District Culture Officer (DCO)

- i. Facilitate in securing land for cultural infrastructure.
- ii. Leads the development and rehabilitation process, overseeing project management and liaising with relevant stakeholders.
- iii. Collaborates with Ward Development Committees (WDCs) to understand community needs and priorities for cultural infrastructure.
- iv. Works with the Department of Finance to secure funding and manage project budgets.

1.4.2 Engineering Department:

- i. Provides technical expertise in design, construction, and renovation of cultural facilities, ensuring adherence to building codes and safety standards
- ii. Collaborates with the DCO throughout the project lifecycle to translate cultural needs into functional designs and specifications.
- iii. Oversees the construction or rehabilitation process, managing contractors and ensuring quality control.

1.4.3 Community Development Officer:

Facilitates communication with community members and gathers their input throughout the development or rehabilitation process.

1.4.4 Department of Finance:

- i. Manages budget allocation for cultural programs, following established financial regulations.
- ii. Reviews and approves funding requests submitted by the DCO, ensuring alignment with overall financial goals and resource availability.
- iii. Provides financial oversight throughout the project lifecycle.
- iv. Submission of quarterly expenditure returns to the ministry responsible for cultural matters.

1.4.5 Procurement Unit:

- i. Works closely with the DCO and Engineering Department to procure necessary materials, equipment, and services for construction or rehabilitation projects, following established procurement procedures.
- ii. Ensures timely and cost-effective acquisition of resources.

1.4.6 Ward Development Committees (WDCs):

- i. Collaborate with the DCO to identify cultural infrastructure needs and priorities within their wards.
- ii. Facilitate community engagement throughout the development or rehabilitation process, gathering input and promoting awareness.
- iii. Assist in mobilising community resources for potential project contributions.

1.5. Procedures

1.5.1 Needs Assessment and Planning

- i. Identify Needs: Conduct a comprehensive assessment to identify existing cultural infrastructure and facilities within the district.
- ii. Evaluate Condition: Assess the current condition of each facility, including structural integrity, accessibility, and suitability for intended use.
- iii. Community Consultation: Organize meetings and workshops with community members to understand their needs and preferences for cultural spaces.
- iv. Develop Project Plan: Based on the needs assessment and community input, develop a project plan outlining the scope of work, timeline, budget, and resource requirements.
- v. Prioritization: Prioritize projects based on urgency, community need, and potential impact.

1.5.2 Project Management

- i. Design and Procurement: Develop project designs that consider functionality, cultural relevance, accessibility, and sustainability. Procure necessary materials and services through a transparent bidding process.
- ii. Construction or Rehabilitation: Oversee construction or rehabilitation works, ensuring adherence to plans, safety regulations, and quality standards.
- iii. Monitoring and Evaluation: Monitor project progress, address any challenges, and evaluate project outcomes upon completion.
- iv. Develop a Maintenance Plan: Establish a plan for ongoing maintenance and preservation of cultural facilities to ensure their longevity.
- v. Explore Funding Opportunities: Identify and explore sustainable funding sources for future development and rehabilitation projects, for instance CDF.

1.6. Communication

- i. Maintain open communication with relevant stakeholders throughout the process, including community members, district officials, and cultural organizations.
- ii. Regularly update stakeholders on project progress and address any concerns.

1.7. Reporting

- i. Prepare a completion report for each project, documenting the process, challenges overcome, and lessons learned.
- ii. Submit reports to relevant authorities and share key findings with the local community.

1.8. Review and Update

This SOP will be reviewed periodically to ensure its effectiveness and adaptation to changing needs or best practices in cultural infrastructure development.

2.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Promoting and Marketing Cultural Goods (Products) and Services in Districts by Local Authorities

2.1. Introduction

This SOP outlines procedures for local authorities to effectively promote and market cultural goods (products) and services within their district following the devolution of cultural functions. This will support the growth of cultural heritage and creative industries (CCIs) and enhance the district's cultural vibrancy.

2.2. Scope

This SOP applies to promoting cultural tourism and utilizing cultural and traditional media of a diverse range of cultural goods and services produced in the district, including:

- i. Traditional arts and crafts
- ii. Cultural performances (music, dance, theater)
- iii. Literary works (books, poetry)
- iv. Visual arts (paintings, sculptures)
- v. Cultural tourism experiences (festivals, historical sites, workshops)
- vi. Educational programs related to local culture
- vii. Design and fashion products with cultural influences

2.3. Purpose

- i. Develop a strategic approach of promoting cultural tourism and utilizing cultural and traditional media produced within the district.
- ii. Increase the visibility and accessibility of local cultural artifacts to a wider audience.
- iii. Stimulate economic growth within the CCIs sector by supporting local cultural entrepreneurs and businesses.
- iv. Foster a sense of cultural pride and identity within the local community.
- v. Facilitate documentation on the promotion and marketing cultural goods (products) and services in the district.

2.4. Roles and Responsibilities

2.4.1 District Culture Officer (DCO)

- i. Leads and collaborates with the TDO and other stakeholders to develop and implement a comprehensive cultural tourism promotion strategy.
- ii. Provides guidance on incorporating cultural heritage elements into marketing and promotional materials to ensure authenticity.
- iii. Oversees the development and implementation of cultural tourism programs and initiatives.

- iv. Liaises with cultural stakeholders, including local artists, artisans, and businesses, to ensure their needs and perspectives are incorporated into promotional efforts.
- v. Monitors and evaluates the effectiveness of cultural tourism initiatives and makes recommendations for improvement.

2.4.2 Tourism Development Officer:

- i. Collaborate with the DCO to craft a comprehensive marketing strategy to promote cultural tourism. This might involve identifying target audiences, choosing appropriate marketing channels, and developing targeted messaging.
- ii. Handle communication efforts like press releases, social media campaigns, and website content creation to reach a wider audience.
- iii. Work with the DCO to organize cultural events, festivals, or workshops to showcase local cultural products and services.

2.4.3 Local Cultural Entrepreneurs and Businesses:

- i. Collaborate with the DCO and TDO in developing promotional initiatives. This could involve participating in workshops, trade shows, and cultural events to showcase their products and services.
- ii. Provide high-quality photos, videos, and descriptions of their products and services for use in promotional materials. Participate in promotional initiatives and provide information about their products and services.
- iii. Collaborate with the DCO and TDO to design unique cultural tourism packages that combine various cultural offerings.
- iv. Attend training sessions or workshops offered by the DCO and TDO to improve marketing and business skills.

2.4.4 Department of Finance:

- i. Work with the DCO to develop a realistic budget for promotional activities based on the marketing strategy. They will also monitor spending throughout the process to ensure financial accountability.
- ii. Submission of quarterly expenditure returns to the ministry responsible for Cultural Matters.

2.4.5 Head of Procurement Unit:

- i. Ensure all printing and marketing materials needed for promotional campaigns are procured efficiently and in compliance with established procedures.
- ii. Select vendors who offer the best value for money for printing services and other marketing materials.
- iii. Work with the DCO and TDO to ensure marketing materials are procured and delivered on time for planned promotional activities.

2.5. Procedures

2.5.1 Inventory and Assessment

- i. Create a comprehensive inventory of cultural artifacts and services produced within the district.
- ii. Evaluate the market potential of different cultural artifacts, considering tourist appeal, local demand, and emerging trends.

2.5.2 Develop a Marketing Strategy

- i. Define the target audience for each cultural product or service (tourists, local residents, specific cultural communities).
- ii. Craft compelling messages that highlight the unique value proposition and cultural significance of local artifacts.
- iii. Choose appropriate marketing channels based on target audience and budget (social media, local events, cultural festivals, online marketplaces, partnerships with tourism agencies).

2.5.3 Implement Marketing Initiatives

- i. Create visually appealing brochures, website content, social media posts, and promotional videos.
- ii. Host cultural events, exhibitions, and workshops to showcase local talent and products.
- iii. Collaborate with other districts, cultural organisations, and tourism agencies for cross-promotion.
- iv. Establish an online presence through a dedicated website or social media channels for continuous promotion.

2.5.4 Monitoring and Evaluation

- i. Monitor the effectiveness of marketing campaigns by collecting data on website traffic, social media engagement, and sales figures.
- ii. Regularly assess the impact of marketing initiatives and adjust strategies based on data and feedback.

2.6. Capacity Building

- i. Offer workshops and training programs for local cultural entrepreneurs and businesses to enhance their marketing skills.
- ii. Facilitate networking opportunities between local cultural artisan to foster collaboration and knowledge sharing.

2.7. Reporting

- i. Prepare quarterly reports on the progress of marketing initiatives, highlighting key achievements and challenges encountered.
- ii. Share reports with the Ministry Responsible for Cultural Matters, Director-Housing and Social Services, district officials, cultural stakeholders, and participating cultural entrepreneurs.

2.8. Review and Update

This SOP shall be reviewed periodically to ensure it aligns with evolving marketing trends and the changing landscape of the CCIs sector.

3.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Registration of Cultural Institutions and Practitioners in Districts by Local Authorities

3.1. Introduction

This SOP outlines the procedures for local authorities to effectively register all cultural institutions and practitioners within their district following the devolution of cultural functions. This comprehensive registry will provide valuable information for cultural planning, resource allocation, and supporting the district's cultural ecosystem.

3.2. Scope

This SOP applies to the registration of all cultural institutions and practitioners within the district, including:

- i. Cultural Institutions:
- ii. Community museums, cultural archives, and libraries with a cultural focus.
- iii. Performance venues (theaters, amphitheaters).
- iv. Cultural centers and community arts centers.
- v. Educational institutions offering cultural programs or training.
- vi. Cultural Practitioners:
- vii. Craftspeople.
- viii. Writers, storytellers, and oral historians.
- ix. Cultural educators and workshop facilitators.

3.3. Purpose

- i. Establish a centralized registry of all cultural institutions and practitioners operating within the district.
- ii. Streamline the registration process for cultural entities.
- iii. Gather comprehensive data on the cultural landscape of the district.
- iv. Facilitate communication and collaboration between local authorities, institutions, and practitioners.
- v. Identify potential areas for support and development within the district's cultural sector.
- vi. Facilitate documentation on the registration of cultural institutions and practitioners in the district.

3.4. Roles and Responsibilities

3.4.1 District Culture Officer (DCO)

- i. Facilitates the registration process
- ii. Manages the cultural registration database
- iii. Liaises with cultural stakeholders
- iv. Monitor the registered cultural institution and practitioner

3.4.2 Registration Staff:

- i. Processes registration applications
- ii. Verifies information, and issues registration certificates.

3.5. Procedures

3.5.1 Implement User Friendly Registration Forms

- i. To streamline data collection and maintain an accurate inventory of cultural resources, pre-designed user-friendly registration forms will be implemented for both cultural institutions and practitioners
- ii. These forms will capture essential information such as:
 - a. Name and contact details
 - b. Type of cultural activity or service provided
 - c. Legal status (private, non-profit, etc.)
 - d. Years of operation
 - e. Target audience
 - f. Website and social media links (if applicable)

3.5.2 Registration Process

- i. Establish a clear and accessible registration process for cultural entities. This can involve online applications, in-person registration at designated locations, or a combination of both.
- ii. Clearly communicate registration requirements, deadlines, and fees (if applicable).
- iii. Provide support to applicants who require assistance with completing the forms.

3.5.3 Utilize Standardized Database for Cultural Information

- i. The district will leverage a standardized database developed by the Ministry to store all collected information on registered cultural institutions and practitioners. Data entry will be completed by designated staff following Ministry guidelines.

- ii. Utilizing this centralized database ensures consistency across districts, facilitates data sharing with relevant authorities such as the Ministry of Tourism and Department of Planning in the Local Authority.
- iii. Regularly update and maintain the database to ensure accuracy.
- iv. Implement data security measures to protect sensitive information such as user access controls, password protocols, and regular data backups.

3.5.4 Issuing Registration Certificates

- i. Upon successful registration, issue a unique registration certificate to each cultural entity.
- ii. The certificate can serve as a form of recognition and may be required for accessing certain benefits or opportunities.

3.6. Communication and Outreach

- i. Launch an awareness campaign to inform cultural institutions and practitioners about the registration process.
- ii. Utilise various communication channels such as local media, cultural centers, and online platforms.
- iii. Organise workshops or information sessions to provide guidance on completing registration forms.

3.7. Review and Update

This SOP will be reviewed periodically to ensure its effectiveness and adapt to any changes in registration requirements or data collection needs.

The registration forms and database may be updated to reflect evolving trends within the cultural sector.

4.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Research and Inventorying Intangible and Tangible Heritage in Districts by Local Authorities

4.1. Introduction

This SOP outlines the process for local authorities to conduct an inventory of cultural practices, activities, assets, tools, and equipment within their districts. This information is crucial for safeguarding cultural heritage, promoting tourism, and informing cultural development initiatives.

4.2. Scope

This SOP applies to the process undertaken by local authorities to conduct a comprehensive inventory of cultural elements within their districts. This inventory will encompass the following:

4.3. Purpose

- i. **Document and Safeguard Cultural Heritage:** The inventory will create a permanent record of the cultural wealth within each district, ensuring its preservation for future generations.
- ii. **Inform Tourism Development:** By identifying cultural assets and activities, this inventory will provide valuable information for promoting sustainable tourism and economic development in the district.
- iii. **Support Cultural Development Initiatives:** The data collected will inform strategic planning and decision-making regarding cultural programs, resource allocation, and safeguarding endangered cultural practices.
- iv. **Cultural Diversity and Identity:** Promote understanding and appreciation of cultural diversity, fostering a sense of identity and continuity within communities.
- v. **Educational and Academic Value:** Support educational and academic initiatives by providing comprehensive resources on heritage, aiding in the dissemination of knowledge.

4.3.1 Tangible

- i. **Cultural Practices:** Traditional ceremonies, rituals, performances, and other expressions of cultural heritage.
- ii. **Cultural Activities:** Storytelling, handicrafts, music, and other practices that contribute to the cultural life of the community.
- iii. **Cultural Assets:** Buildings, monuments, artifacts, historical sites, and sacred places that hold cultural significance.
- iv. **Tools and Equipment:** Instruments, looms, tools for food production, and other implements used in traditional practices and crafts.

4.3.2. Intangible

- i. **Traditional Knowledge:** Oral traditions, folklore, indigenous languages, medicinal practices, agricultural techniques, and ecological knowledge systems.
- ii. **Performing Arts:** Traditional dances, music, theater, puppetry, storytelling, and other forms of performing arts.
- iii. **Social Practices:** Customs, rites of passage, community rituals, festivals, ceremonies, traditional recipes, cooking techniques, food rituals, and culinary practices.
- iv. **Knowledge and practices concerning nature and universe:** The value of preserving and promoting traditional ecological knowledge in the face of modern environmental challenges.
- v. **Craftsmanship and Skills:** Artisanal skills, craftsmanship, traditional craftsmanship techniques, and craftsmanship associated with specific trades.

4.4. Roles and Responsibilities

4.4.1 District Culture Officer (DCO)

- i. Oversees the entire inventory process, ensuring team collaboration, data quality control, and collaboration with academic institutions and researchers.
- ii. Conducts field visits to identify and document both tangible and intangible cultural heritage.
- iii. Engages with local communities to gather oral histories, traditions, and cultural practices.
- iv. Maintains and updates the inventory database to reflect new findings, changes, and research contributions.
- v. Provides training and support to local staff and volunteers involved in the inventory process.
- vi. Ensures ethical handling and documentation of cultural heritage information.
- vii. Develops partnerships with academic institutions and researchers to conduct collaborative research projects, disseminate information, and promote awareness and conservation of cultural heritage.
- viii. Secures funding, oversees safeguarding measures, and reports findings to relevant authorities (Ministry of Tourism, local community).

4.4.2 Local Cultural Specialists:

- i. Accompany DCO and field teams during site visits to identify and document tangible and intangible cultural heritage.
- ii. Facilitate communication with community members, acting as cultural interpreters and ensuring respectful interactions.
- iii. Facilitate communication with community members, acting as cultural interpreters and ensuring respectful interactions.
- iv. Assist the DCO in analyzing and interpreting the collected data, identifying patterns, and ensuring cultural context is preserved.
- v. Contribute their knowledge to categorize and classify cultural elements within the inventory database.
- vi. Identify potential gaps in the inventory and suggest areas requiring further research or documentation.

4.4.3 District Information Officer (ZANIS)

- i. Collaborates with the DCO to develop communication strategies for raising awareness about the inventory program and disseminating findings to the public. This may involve producing press releases, public announcements, social media content, and (in collaboration with the DCO and cultural specialists) documentaries for television and radio.
- ii. The District Information Officer can leverage their knowledge of broadcast media to develop scripts, conduct interviews, and contribute to the overall production process of these documentaries. (Note: ZANIS refers to Zambia News and Information Services)

4.4.4 Librarian:

Assists with securing collected data in a safe and organized manner. This may involve ensuring proper storage facilities, establishing data archiving protocols, and facilitating data retrieval for future reference.

4.4.5 Department of Finance:

- i. Collaborates with the DCO during the planning phase to review and approve the inventory programme budget.
- ii. Allocates necessary funds for personnel, data collection tools, transportation, and other programme-related expenses.
- iii. Monitors expenditures to ensure adherence to the approved budget.
- iv. Submits quarterly expenditure returns to the ministry responsible for culture.

4.5. Procedures

4.5.1 Planning and Preparation

- i. Facilitate meetings with community leaders, cultural practitioners, and knowledgeable individuals to identify cultural elements for documentation.
- ii. Consult historians, cultural specialists, and relevant professionals for a comprehensive understanding of local heritage.
- iii. Conduct surveys and mapping exercises to locate and document tangible and intangible cultural elements.
- iv. Develop standardized forms and templates based on UNESCO guidelines for consistent data recording.
- v. Secure necessary permissions for accessing cultural sites or interviewing community members.
- vi. Train local staff and volunteers on data collection methods, cultural protocols, and terminology.

4.5.2 Data Collection

- i. DCO and field teams (including Local Cultural Specialists) visit cultural sites to document existing assets, tools, equipment, and practices.
- ii. Capture comprehensive visual (Photography and Videography) documentation of tangible and intangible cultural assets.
- iii. Use standardized forms to collect data on cultural elements, including:
 - a. Description
 - b. Significance in the local culture
 - c. Frequency of practice/use
 - d. Materials used (for tools/equipment)
 - e. Location (for assets)
 - f. Condition
 - g. Potential threats (for all elements)
- iv. Conduct ethnographic research to document intangible cultural practices, including participant observation, interviews, and audiovisual recordings (with community consent). Cultural Specialists can guide this process.
- v. Record and document oral traditions, including storytelling, songs, chants, verbal expressions, traditional ecological knowledge, and indigenous technologies. Local Cultural specialists can assist with translation and interpretation.
- vi. Enter collected data into a designated database management system for centralised storage and analysis.

4.5.3 Quality Control and Data Management

- i. Conduct internal reviews to ensure data accuracy and completeness.
- ii. Regularly back up the collected data in a secure location.
- iii. Maintain a long-term storage plan for the inventory data and collected media (photos, videos).

4.6. Reporting

- i. Upon completion of the inventory, prepare a comprehensive report summarising the findings.
- ii. Include detailed descriptions, photographs, and any relevant data visualisations.
- iii. ZANIS collaborates with DCO to develop communication strategies and disseminate findings to the public.
- iv. Disseminate the report to relevant stakeholders, including district officials, cultural institutions, community members, and the Ministry.

4.7. Communication

- i. Maintain open communication with district officials, community leaders, and cultural stakeholders throughout the inventory process.
- ii. Address any concerns or questions promptly.
- iii. Organise community presentations or workshops to share the inventory findings and their significance.

5.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Mobilisation and Facilitation of Community Participation in Cultural and Traditional Affairs Activities in Districts by Local Authorities

5.1. Introduction

This SOP outlines the procedures for local authorities to effectively mobilise and facilitate community participation in cultural and traditional affairs activities within their district. Encouraging active community involvement is crucial for preserving cultural heritage, fostering a sense of cultural identity, and creating vibrant cultural spaces.

5.2. Scope

This SOP applies to mobilising and facilitating community participation in various cultural activities, including:

- i. Traditional ceremonies and festivals
- ii. Cultural performances (music, dance, theater)
- iii. Workshops on traditional crafts and skills
- iv. Storytelling sessions and oral history preservation initiatives
- v. Community-led cultural events and initiatives
- vi. Official and State Functions

5.3. Purpose

- i. Develop strategies to engage community members in cultural activities (including providing entertainment for official and state functions) and provide support to ensure inclusive participation.
- ii. Promote a sense of ownership and responsibility for the district's cultural heritage and traditional affairs.
- iii. Work with relevant individuals and organizations to support cultural initiatives.
- iv. Leverage community knowledge and skills to revitalize cultural practices and traditions.
- v. Facilitate documentation of cultural activities and mobilization efforts for future reference and knowledge sharing

5.4. Roles and Responsibilities

5.4.1 District Cultural Officer (DCO):

- i. Leads mobilization and facilitation efforts for cultural activities.
- ii. Identifies community cultural needs and resources.
- iii. Collaborates with cultural stakeholders to improve programs.
- iv. Ensures effective organization of cultural events (festivals, ceremonies, exhibitions) to promote national identity and cultural tourism.
- v. Provides cultural entertainment for state and public functions.

5.4.2 Community Development Officer (CDO):

- i. Assist DCO in conducting needs assessments to better understand the interests and skills within the community for specific cultural activities (workshops, storytelling sessions).
- ii. Identify and secure resources within the community (e.g., venues, equipment) and connect with potential sponsors to support events.
- iii. Conduct training sessions for community members on leadership skills, event planning, or grant writing to empower them to organize future initiatives.
- iv. Track participation rates and gather feedback from community members to evaluate the success of cultural activities and inform future planning.
- v. Provide expertise in community mobilization techniques and works with local leaders to engage residents.

5.4.3 Tourism Development Officer

- i. Collaborate with the DCO to identify and package cultural elements (festivals, crafts, storytelling) as tourist experiences.
- ii. Utilize marketing expertise to advertise cultural activities through brochures, social media, and partnerships with travel agencies. Explore revenue generation from tourism and advocate for funding cultural activities.
- iii. Promote infrastructure development near cultural sites and collaborate on training programs for local communities involved in tourism
- iv. Work with DCO to track visitor data and analyze its impact on cultural activities and the local economy.

5.4.4 Cultural Specialists:

- i. Collaborate with DCO and community members to develop engaging and informative content for workshops, storytelling sessions, or cultural performances.
- ii. Mentor and guide younger generations in traditional crafts, music, dance, or storytelling to ensure cultural preservation.
- iii. Assist with documenting cultural activities (e.g., photos, videos) and contribute to archiving cultural knowledge through oral histories or creating written resources.
- iv. Collaborate with DCO to develop cultural exchange programs with other communities to foster intercultural understanding and appreciation.

5.4.5 Community Leaders and Volunteers:

- i. Spread awareness about cultural activities through community channels (e.g., social media, local gatherings) to encourage participation.
- ii. Assist with registration, group formation, and managing participant needs during activities.

- iii. Work with CDO to identify fundraising opportunities or secure sponsorships from local businesses to support cultural initiatives.
- iv. Identify and address any accessibility barriers (e.g., transportation, language) to ensure everyone feels welcome to participate.

5.4.6 Director of Finance

- i. Provides financial guidance and cost estimates during program planning
- ii. Assists the DCO in developing a realistic and achievable budget request based on available resources.
- iii. Reviews and approves budget requests submitted by the DCO, ensuring alignment with overall financial goals, resource availability, and established financial regulations.
- iv. Provides ongoing financial oversight throughout implementation, monitoring expenditures against the approved budget.
- v. Submission of quarterly expenditure returns to the ministry responsible for cultural matters.

5.4.7 Procurement Unit:

- i. Acquires necessary materials and resources for cultural activities following established procedures.
- ii. Manages inventory of cultural supplies, ensuring adherence to purchasing policies, and potentially negotiating vendor contracts.

5.5. Procedures

5.5.1 Community Needs Assessment

- i. Conduct a needs assessment to identify existing cultural activities and potential areas of interest for community participation.
- ii. Gather information through community meetings, focus group discussions, and surveys.
- iii. In addition to identifying community interests, consider the potential appeal of cultural activities for tourists when conducting needs assessment.
- iv. The DCO and TDO will work collaboratively to assess the needs and interests of the community, with the TDO providing insights on tourist preferences.

5.5.2 Stakeholder Mapping

Identify and map key cultural stakeholders within the community, including cultural practitioners, community organizations, potential sponsors, and tourism businesses.

5.5.3 Mobilisation Strategy Implementation

- i. Implement a mobilisation strategy based on the needs assessment findings.
- ii. Identify key target groups within the community and tailor outreach efforts accordingly.
- iii. Utilise various communication channels to reach out to the community, such as local media, community meetings, and social media platforms.
- iv. Partner with existing community organisations and cultural groups to leverage their networks.
- v. Implement strategies to promote cultural activities to potential tourists through tourism marketing channels

5.5.4 Facilitation Techniques

- i. Employ inclusive facilitation techniques to ensure all community members feel welcome and encouraged to participate.
- ii. Create a safe and respectful environment for open dialogue and sharing of cultural knowledge.
- iii. Utilise participatory activities and workshops to engage community members in planning and decision-making processes.
- iv. Provide capacity building workshops to equip community members with skills to organize and lead cultural activities.

5.5.5 Building Partnerships

- i. Foster partnerships with local cultural practitioners, artists, and educators to contribute their expertise to cultural events.
- ii. Collaborate with educational institutions to integrate cultural activities into school programs.
- iii. Partner with private businesses for potential sponsorships or support for community cultural initiatives.
- iv. Partner with travel agencies and tour operators to integrate cultural activities into tourist itineraries

5.5.6 Monitoring and Evaluation:

- i. Monitor the effectiveness of mobilization and facilitation efforts through feedback mechanisms.
- ii. Conduct post-event evaluations to assess participation levels and identify areas for improvement.
- iii. Track visitor data related to cultural activities to understand their impact on tourism and the local economy

5.6. Sustainability

- i. Implement strategies to ensure the long-term sustainability of community participation in cultural activities.
- ii. Encourage the creation of community-based cultural committees to manage and lead cultural initiatives.
- iii. Explore funding opportunities to support community-led cultural projects.

5.7. Communication

- i. Maintain open communication with community members throughout the mobilisation and facilitation process.
- ii. Regularly update the community on upcoming cultural activities and opportunities for their participation.
- iii. Utilise various communication channels to ensure information reaches all segments of the community.

5.8. Review and Update

This SOP shall be periodically reviewed to ensure it reflects evolving community needs and best practices in community engagement.

6.0 Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for Supervision, Monitoring, and Evaluation (M&E) of Cultural Institutions, Programs, and Activities in Districts by Local Authorities

6.1. Introduction

This SOP outlines the procedures for local authorities to effectively supervise, monitor, and evaluate (M&E) cultural institutions, programs, and activities within their district following the devolution of cultural functions. A robust M&E system will ensure accountability, efficient resource allocation, and continuous improvement within the district's cultural sector.

6.2. Scope

This SOP applies to the supervision, monitoring, and evaluation of all cultural institutions, programs, and activities under the control of local authorities, including:

- i. Cultural centers, community museums, and cultural archives.
- ii. Performance venues (theaters).
- iii. Cultural programs and activities funded by local authorities.

6.3. Purpose

- i. Establish a framework to monitor progress towards cultural development goals set by local authorities.
- ii. Assess the effectiveness and impact of cultural programs and activities to see if they are achieving their objectives.
- iii. Assess the effectiveness, efficiency, and impact of cultural programs and activities.
- iv. Ensure cultural institutions comply with established regulations and guidelines.

6.4. Roles and Responsibilities

6.4.1 District Culture Officer (DCO)

- i. Coordinates M&E activities, oversees data collection, and ensures comprehensive coverage and timely execution.
- ii. Collaborates with planners to design practical, culturally sensitive M&E plans aligned with program objectives.
- iii. Works with planners to analyze M&E data using appropriate methodologies. Interprets the findings in the context of cultural development goals
- iv. Continuously monitors program implementation, evaluates effectiveness, and identifies areas for improvement.
- v. Provides intervention measures, advises on program adjustments, and suggests actions for enhanced cultural preservation.
- vi. Presents findings and recommendations to relevant authorities, including local government and cultural institutions

6.4.2 Planners:

- i. Work with the DCO to design a comprehensive M&E framework that outlines indicators, data collection methods, and reporting processes aligned with cultural development goals.
- ii. Assist the DCO in facilitating a participatory planning process where cultural institutions and communities provide input on culturally sensitive M&E plans.
- iii. Provide technical expertise in data analysis, working with the DCO to apply appropriate techniques and draw insights from collected data.
- iv. Assist the DCO in preparing clear and concise M&E reports tailored to different audiences.

6.4.3 Department of Finance:

- i. Reviews M&E budget requests submitted by the DCO, ensuring alignment with overall financial goals and resource availability.
- ii. Allocates funding for M&E activities as budgeted, following established financial procedures.
- iii. May participate in the M&E process by providing financial data and analysis relevant to program evaluation.
- iv. Submission of quarterly expenditure returns to the ministry responsible for cultural matters.

6.5. Procedures

6.5.1 M&E Framework Development

- i. DCO collaborates with the Planners to develop a comprehensive M&E framework that outlines the objectives of cultural programs and activities, desired outcomes, and key performance indicators (KPIs) for measurement.
- ii. Ensure the M&E framework aligns with the district's overall cultural development strategy.

6.5.2 Supervision

- i. DCO conducts regular supervisory visits to cultural institutions to assess compliance with regulations, resource utilisation, and adherence to program plans.
- ii. Provide ongoing support and guidance to cultural institutions.

6.5.3 Monitoring

- i. Establish mechanisms for ongoing data collection on program implementation, participation levels, and resource utilisation.
- ii. Utilise data collection methods such as attendance records, surveys, and performance reports from cultural institutions.
- iii. Monitor progress towards achieving program objectives based on established KPIs.

6.5.4 Evaluation

- i. DCO working with Planners conducts periodic evaluations of cultural programs and activities to assess their effectiveness, efficiency, and impact.
- ii. Utilise various evaluation methodologies such as outcome evaluations, cost-benefit analyses, and stakeholder satisfaction surveys.
- iii. Identify best practices and lessons learned from evaluations to inform future program development.

6.5.5 Reporting

- i. Prepare regular reports summarising monitoring findings and evaluation results.
- ii. Disseminate reports to relevant stakeholders, including cultural institutions, program managers, district officials, and the community.

6.6. Communication

- i. Maintain open communication with cultural institutions, program managers, and relevant stakeholders throughout the M&E process.
- ii. Provide regular feedback on program performance and areas for improvement.

6.7. Review and Update

Review the M&E framework and procedures periodically to ensure their effectiveness and adapt to changing needs or best practices.

Update KPIs and data collection methods as needed.

7.0 Roles and Responsibilities for Ministry of Tourism (MoT) in Cultural Matters

7.1. Monitoring and Reporting

- i. The MoT will develop frameworks and tools for LAs to report on their performance in managing cultural initiatives and delivering cultural services. This may involve standardized reporting templates and periodic data collection exercises of the implementation of cultural programs in order to provide appropriate intervention measures on Zambian culture.
- ii. MoT will analyze reports to assess LA compliance with national cultural development policies and strategies. Feedback will be provided to LAs, highlighting areas of success and areas requiring improvement.

7.2. Technical Support

- i. The MoT will offer expertise and guidance to LAs in various aspects of cultural management, including:
 - a. Cultural Policy Development: Assisting LAs in developing and implementing local cultural policies aligned with national strategies.
 - b. Cultural Heritage Management: Providing guidance on inventorying, documenting, safeguarding, and promoting local cultural heritage.
 - c. Cultural Programming: Sharing best practices for developing and delivering engaging cultural programs that cater to diverse audiences.
 - d. International Cultural Co-operation: Advises and guides on cultural international conventions and agreements in order to promote cultural exchange to foster International Cultural Cooperation.
 - e. Cultural Tourism Development: Offering advice on integrating cultural heritage into tourism strategies to promote sustainable cultural tourism practices.
 - f. Resource mobilization: Integrate resource mobilization strategies for LA cultural programs into technical support. This could include grant writing workshops, connecting LAs with potential funding sources, and advocating for increased cultural budgets.
 - g. Infrastructure development: Offer guidance on securing funding for construction and renovation of cultural facilities, such as museums and community centers.
 - h. Traditional ceremonies: Provide support for the documentation, preservation, and potential funding of traditional ceremonies, considering community needs and cultural sensitivity.
- ii. MoT can provide technical support through workshops, training sessions, online resources, and one-on-one consultations with LA cultural officers.

7.3. Capacity Building

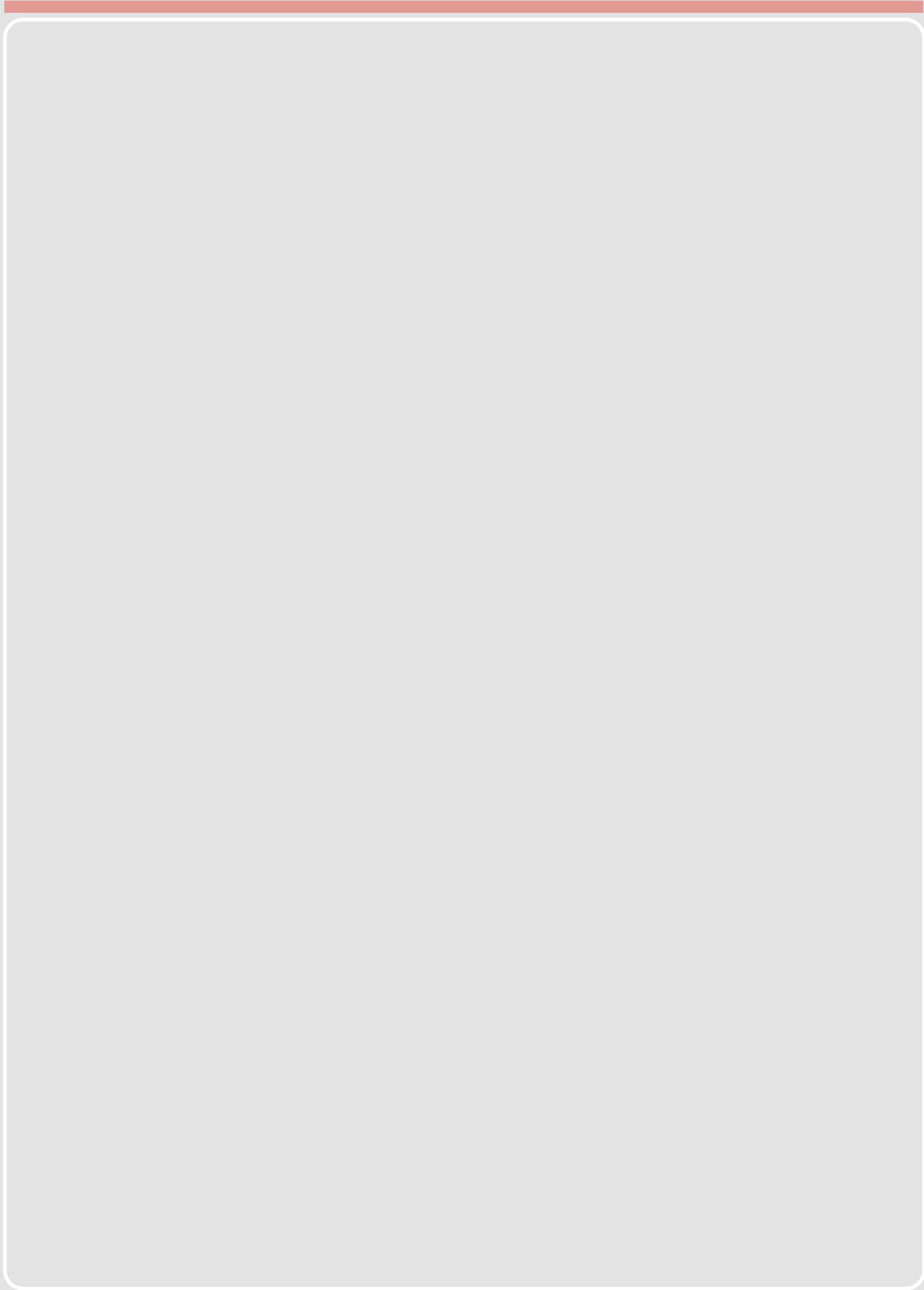
- i. The MoT will invest in initiatives to build the capacity of LA staff responsible for cultural development. This may involve:
 - a. Training Programs: Organizing workshops on cultural policy development, heritage management, cultural programming, and tourism integration.
 - b. Mentorship Programs: Pairing experienced MoT staff with LA cultural officers for knowledge transfer and on-the-job support.
 - c. Exchange Programs: Facilitating exchange programs between LAs and other cultural institutions to share best practices and foster collaboration.

7.4. Quality Assurance / Audit

- i. MoT will conduct periodic audits of LA cultural programs and activities to assess adherence to national standards and best practices. Audits may focus on areas like financial management, programme implementation, and cultural heritage preservation efforts.
- ii. Based on audit findings, MoT will provide recommendations for improvement and offer technical assistance to address identified shortcomings.

7.5. Supervision and Oversight

- i. MoT will maintain a supervisory role to ensure LAs comply with national cultural legislation and regulations. This may involve:
 - a. Providing guidance on legal requirements for cultural heritage management and protection.
 - b. Offering advice on resolving complex cultural issues that LAs may encounter.
 - c. Liaising with other government agencies to secure resources and support for LA cultural initiatives.





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